

José Miguel Parella, open source CTO at Microsoft, and Balaji Kesavraj, director - platform strategy & marketing, Microsoft, were both at Open Source India (OSI) held at Bengaluru in November last year. In a freewheeling chat with Rahul Chopra and Manvi Saxena of OSFY, they gave insights on containers, Azure, Microsoft's open source strategy, and a lot more.



José Miguel Parella, CTO, Microsoft

“We have a fairly mature open source strategy, though it’s not perfect”

RC: What does it mean to be a CTO of a tech centre in Microsoft? Typically, a CTO defines all the technologies being adopted or being worked upon within an organisation, but this is a particular group, here. Can you share something more about your role?

José : Well, my role here is to help the traditional Microsoft business to understand the technological ecosystem.

RC: Is it more of an ‘inward’ role?

José : Right! I do a lot of internal evangelism, with the traditional, conventional, sales and marketing groups at Microsoft, etc, to help them understand the open source philosophy, the emotions that drive the community, how

it works and also to understand the emerging technologies well. So it’s just not about the technology for business, but integrating an open source ecosystem with the traditional Microsoft business, which has been very successful in serving technology for many, many years. We needed this traditional business to be very successful in selling open source too. That’s what my role is about—I have to work very closely with the engineers. I am an open source developer myself, but I don’t get hands-on with the products. I also have to be active with what we call a ‘field’, where my colleagues attend conferences in many countries, like Open Source India. We go there, talk to the community, and build a relationship with them. I am also